

University of Utah Athletics Recruiting Transformation

A Salesforce Based Process Optimization and
Compliance Solution

Report Submitted as Part of the Salesforce IDEAthlon
Competition conducted by the University of Utah IS
program

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Purpose

The objective is to create a Salesforce-based recruiting system that will improve reporting, communication, and NCAA compliance for all sports teams while centralizing athlete prospect data and standardizing recruiting practices. The inefficiencies brought about by dispersed hiring records kept in spreadsheets, emails, phone logs, and paper notes are addressed by this method. The Athletics Department may enhance decision-making, minimize lost chances, and guarantee consistent compliance control by combining all recruiting operations under a single CRM platform.

Executive Summary

Student athletes from a variety of sports are recruited by the University of Utah Athletics Department; each sport has its own recruitment schedule, standards for evaluation, and requirements for compliance. Due to the current fragmented nature of recruiting operations, there is a greater risk of compliance, inconsistent communication monitoring, and less visibility into the progress of prospects. There isn't a single system in place for coaches, recruiters, and compliance officers to track athlete engagement from initial contact until commitment.

I started by creating a Salesforce system that uses a custom Athlete Prospect object, structured recruiting phases, automated follow-up procedures, and real-time data dashboards to digitize the whole recruitment lifecycle. Coaches may use the system to manage college visits while automatically keeping an eye on NCAA visit limitations, track interactions across various platforms, including social media, and assess prospects using established scoring systems.

This solution improves recruiting effectiveness by ensuring no prospect is overlooked, communication history is fully documented, and decision makers have instant access to up to date recruiting performance metrics. Compliance officers benefit from centralized visibility into all prospect interactions and automated alerts when visit thresholds are approached. this Salesforce installation offers a data-driven, scalable, and compliant recruitment structure that promotes athletic competition while upholding institutional integrity.

Methodology

To guarantee scalability, usability, and compliance, the project conformed to an organized system design and implementation methodology in line with Salesforce CRM best practices. A thorough evaluation of the University of Utah Athletics Department's current recruiting environment was the first step in the process. Inefficiencies resulting from decentralized data storage, irregular communication monitoring, and restricted insight into prospect advancement were identified by analyzing current operations. Key pain points and functional needs that the system needed to address were identified using input from coaches, recruiting personnel, and compliance officials.

A unique Salesforce data model was created based on the definition of essential recruiting criteria derived from this investigation. The Athlete Prospect object, which acts as the main record for all recruiting activity, is at the core of this concept. Essential prospect data, such as academic records, athletic performance indicators, evaluation results, communication history, and document attachments, were intended to be captured by this item. A comprehensive and consolidated recruiting profile was created by directly linking related objects, such communications and university visits, to the Athlete Prospect record.

The entire athlete lifetime, from initial outreach to commitment, was subsequently reflected in the definition of recruiting stages. Initial Contact, Evaluation, Campus Visit, Offer Extended, and Committed are the phases. Kanban views were used to visually depict the hiring process, and Salesforce Path was set up to lead users through each step by emphasizing necessary fields and suggested actions. Recruiters and coaches may swiftly update prospect status, prioritize outreach efforts, and identify prospects who need immediate attention with the help of these tools.

Salesforce Flows were used to automate tasks in order to decrease manual labor and increase consistency. In order to remind recruiters to take necessary action, such finishing assessments or setting up college visits, automated follow-up reminders were developed. By keeping track of college visit counts and sending out alerts when prospects go close to NCAA visit limits, further automation was utilized to help compliance monitoring.

To ensure system functionality and accuracy, sample prospect, communication, and visit data were loaded into the system. This data supported testing of automations, validation of reports and dashboards, and preparation for live demonstration during the competition.

While recruiting directors had complete visibility across all schools, coaches were only given access to prospects related to their particular sports. To facilitate supervision and auditing, compliance officials were granted read access to all prospect records, correspondence, and visit histories. Were protected at the field level. These controls

guarantee data integrity, safeguard private data, and enable each user group to engage with the system in a manner consistent with their operational requirements.

Findings

The Salesforce solution significantly improves recruiting efficiency and visibility compared to the existing decentralized approach previously used by the Athletics Department. By consolidating all recruiting activity into a single system, Salesforce eliminates the fragmentation caused by spreadsheets, emails, and paper based tracking, reducing the risk of lost information and inconsistent recordkeeping.

All recruitment data, such as evaluations, correspondence, academic records, documents, and past university visits, can be accessed from one place thanks to centralized athlete records. Coaches, recruiters, and compliance personnel may rapidly ascertain a prospect's status, engagement history, and general fit without depending on several sources thanks to this single perspective. Decision-making becomes quicker and better informed as a result.

Prospects can be scored by coaches using color coded priority categories and numerical ratings, enabling objective comparison both within and between sports. When making offer and scholarship decisions, this framework lessens subjectivity and facilitates more transparent prioritization.

Missed engagement is less likely when follow up chores are automated. When action is needed, including finishing assessments, setting up visits, or following up after initial contact, recruiters receive reminders produced by the system. This helps sustain good relationships with prospective student athletes and guarantees prompt and continuous involvement with prospects throughout the recruiting pipeline.

Automated compliance warnings and campus visit tracking improve risk management and oversight. Compliance officers can take action before infractions happen because the system actively tracks visit counts and notifies prospects who are getting close to NCAA limits. Preventative monitoring replaces reactive review in this proactive approach to compliance. The

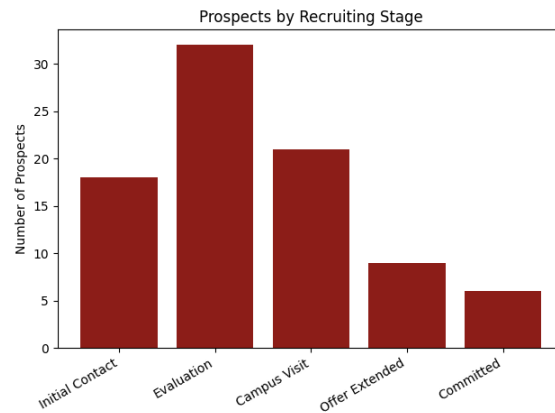
Overall, the Salesforce solution provides greater transparency, accountability, and operational control over the recruiting process. The combination of centralized data, standardized evaluations, automation, and real time reporting creates a more reliable and compliant recruiting environment that supports both competitive athletic recruiting and institutional responsibility.

Recommendations

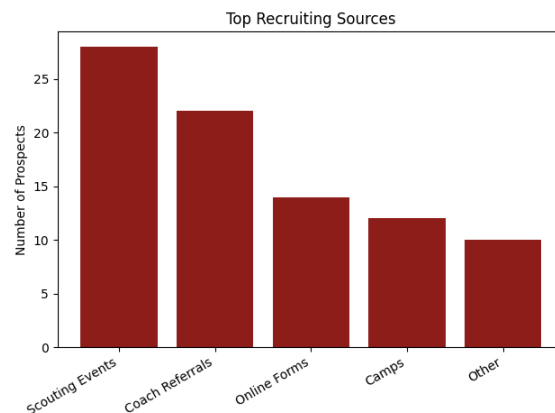
1. Adopt Salesforce as the system of record for all athletic recruiting activities.
2. Require all prospect communications to be logged within Salesforce.
3. Standardize prospect evaluation using numeric ratings and priority color coding.
4. Use automated follow up workflows to ensure consistent recruiter engagement.
5. Monitor campus visits through Salesforce to prevent NCAA compliance violations.
6. Utilize dashboards and recruiting boards to support data driven recruiting decisions.
7. Implement role based access controls to ensure coaches, recruiting staff, and compliance officers only view information relevant to their responsibilities.
8. Provide initial and ongoing Salesforce training for coaches and recruiting staff to promote consistent system adoption and data accuracy.
9. Integrate external performance data sources, such as camp results and testing metrics, to enhance prospect evaluations and reduce manual data entry.
10. Establish standardized data entry guidelines to improve record consistency and reporting reliability across all sports.
11. Conduct regular compliance audits using Salesforce reports to proactively identify and resolve potential NCAA issues.
12. Periodically review recruiting analytics to refine sourcing strategies, visit planning, and scholarship allocation decisions.

Figures

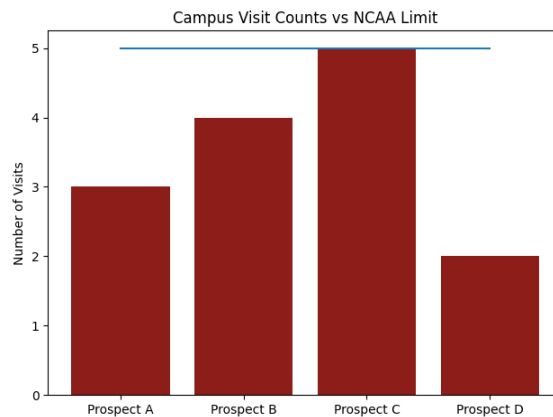
- displays the amount of potential athletes at each level of the recruiting process, such as Initial Contact, Evaluation, Campus Visit, Offer Extended, and Committed. This graphic shows the areas where prospects are concentrated and offers information on the general flow of the recruiting pipeline.



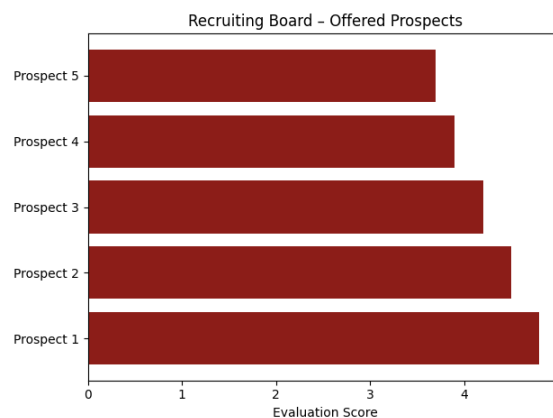
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- Shows how many booked or completed campus visits each recruit has in relation to the NCAA visitation cap. This figure demonstrates how visit activity is monitored to ensure compliance and how prospects nearing visit limits can be quickly identified



- Presents potential candidates in a graphic recruiting board format, ranked by evaluation score. This number enables coaches to prioritize recruiting efforts, assess prospects rapidly, and concentrate on the athletes with the highest ratings.



- Provides an overview of important recruiting metrics, such as total prospects, active offers, impending campus visits, and compliance flags. This statistic helps the athletics department make decisions in real time and offers a high-level summary of recruiting activity.

